

Pillar 4: Custom Definitions & User Properties

Event-Scoped Dimensions & User-Scoped Properties for Reporting and Audience Activation | Apple Omni-Channel Store

PROPERTY NAME

Apple Omni-Channel Store

MEASUREMENT ID

G-X3R766JV6K

EVENT-SCOPED DIMENSION

Product Category (item_category)

USER-SCOPED PROPERTY

Customer Status (customer_type)

01 Context & Scope

The narrative



WHY REGISTRATION IS REQUIRED

Raw parameters sent from Google Tag Manager arrive in GA4's event stream, but they stay invisible to reports and Explorations until they're explicitly registered as Custom Definitions. Registration is the step that turns a raw payload key into a reportable dimension or metric.

The governance distinction that matters here is scope. An **Event-Scoped Dimension** describes something true about a single hit, like which product category a click belonged to, and resets with every new event. A **User-Scoped Property** describes something true about the person across their entire relationship with the property, like whether they're a guest, a registered account holder, or a VIP, and persists across sessions until it's explicitly overwritten. Registering a parameter under the wrong scope quietly breaks the reporting it was meant to enable, so this distinction is enforced deliberately rather than left to whichever scope GTM defaults to.

02 Custom Definition Architecture & Schema

The two registered definitions



Product Category

EVENT-SCOPED · item_category

A hit-level dimension attached to individual e-commerce events, used to break down sales and interaction volume by catalog line, Smartphones, Laptops, Wearables, without needing a separate report per product family.



Customer Status

USER-SCOPED · customer_type

A persistent, cross-session trait (Guest, Registered, VIP) that survives across the customer's full relationship with the property, used for cohort analysis and building high-value remarketing segments.

DIMENSION NAME	SCOPE	PARAMETER	REGISTERED
Customer Status	USER	customer_type	Jul 26, 2026
Product Category	EVENT	item_category	Jul 26, 2026

What registration actually unlocks



Custom Breakdown Tables

GA4 EXPLORATIONS

Both registered dimensions become available as row or column breakdowns inside free-form Explorations, enabling ad hoc tables like revenue by product category, or engagement by customer tier, without waiting on a custom report build.



Dynamic Audience Building

AD TARGETING

The user-scoped Customer Status property feeds directly into GA4's Audience Builder, making it possible to construct a segment like "VIP customers" and push it to Google Ads for high-value remarketing, something an event-scoped dimension alone can't support.

04 Implementation Proof

Visual asset from the demo property

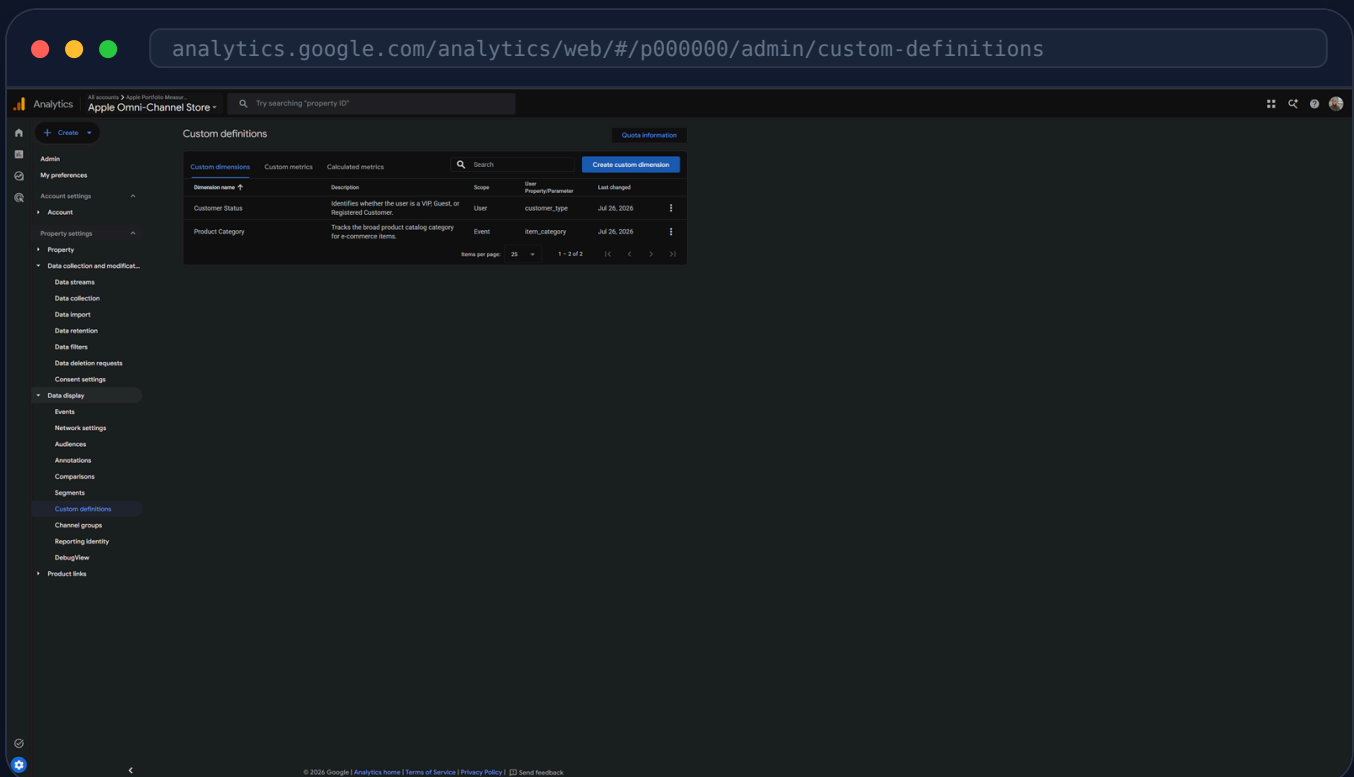


FIG. 5 GA4 Custom Definitions Table — shows the active Event-Scoped (Product Category) and User-Scoped (Customer Status) dimensions registered in the Admin console, both created on Jul 26, 2026, confirming the schema documented in Section 2 is live.